

The state board said no.

The Tribune reports the board voted down the Alpha leaders' AI charter bid. Emails obtained by The Texas Tribune and ProPublica show Texas Education Agency staff helped connect the same AI platform with school districts.



Voted down 10 to 3, the Tribune reports.

ProPublica dates the vote to the summer of 2025. Members cited the use of AI to teach, student screen time and questions about the test gains Alpha leaders presented.



10 IN THE MAJORITY

3 IN THE MINORITY

The commissioner wrote back.

Mike Morath answered Alpha School associates in September 2025. He offered to introduce an Alpha leader to the superintendent he appointed to run the state takeover of Houston ISD.

**"I'd love to
schedule a follow-
up discussion"**

MIKE MORATH,
SEPTEMBER 2025,
AS QUOTED BY
THE TRIBUNE AND
PROPUBLICA



Back again, with six others.

Emails show Morath went back to Alpha's campuses with six other TEA leaders. His staff timed it for the same day as Houston superintendent Mike Miles.



Approached, at least 10. Piloted, 3. Didn't pursue it, 5.

One bus per district in the reporting, and every count is a floor. The 2 set back are approached districts the reporting doesn't name. TEA says it connected interested district leaders and left the choice to them.

PILOT DISTRICTS
HOUSTON, ALDINE,
FORT DAVIS

DIDN'T PURSUE IT
ECTOR COUNTY, FORT BEND,
IRVING, PECOS, PFLUGERVILLE



Extra help, not a two hour day.

Fort Davis ISD enrolls around 800 students. It will use the model in its K-8 classrooms for students who need extra help in reading and math. Alpha's full model has AI teach all students basic subjects in two hours a day.



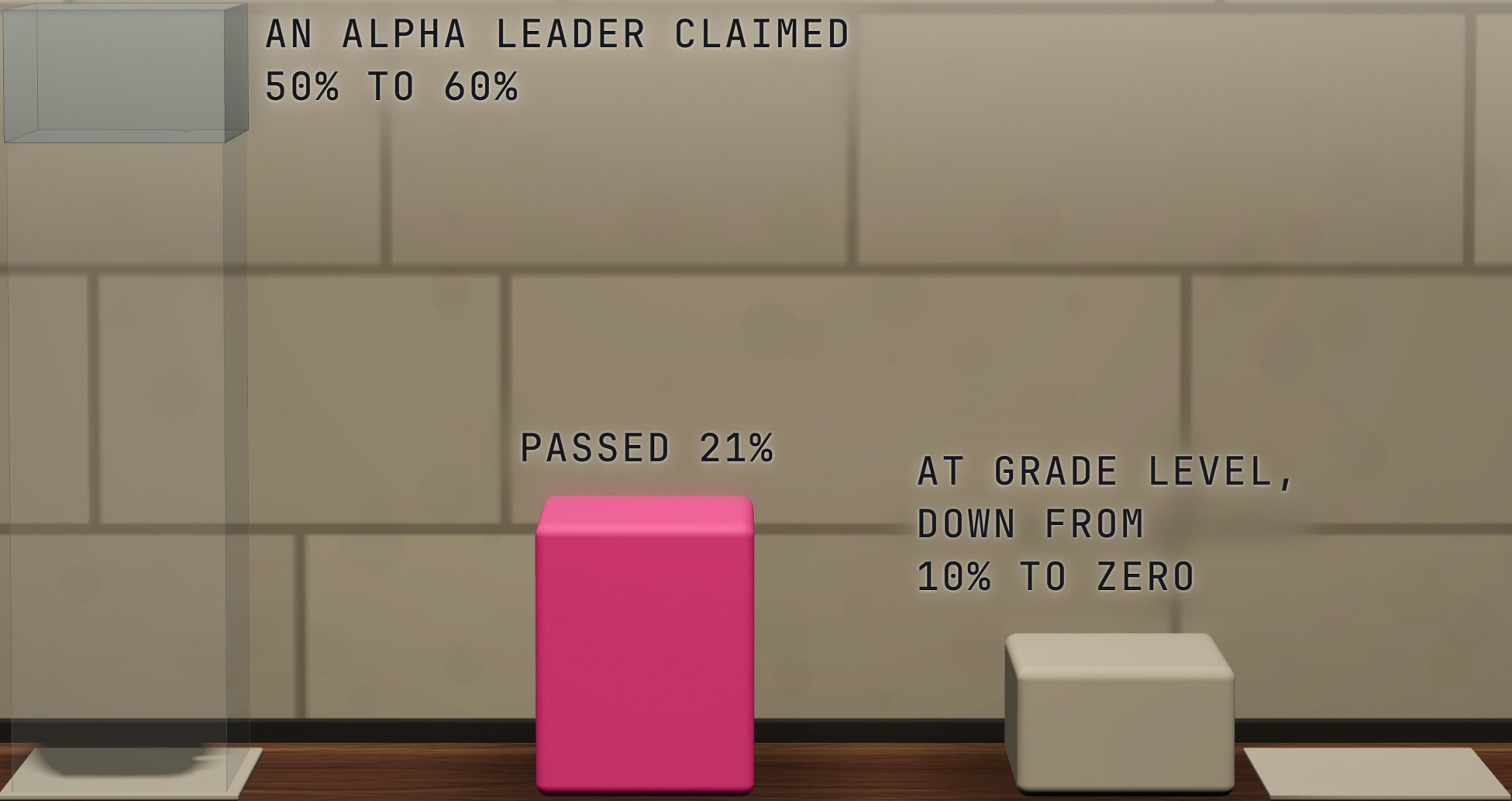
Aldine's pilot spans four middle schools.

Aldine will use the platform with roughly 300 students who need math support. Houston ISD plans to use it for students with strong test scores and says it isn't paying Alpha. The district asked the Texas attorney general to let it withhold the pilot contract.



Claimed 50% to 60%. Passed, 21%.

An Alpha leader told state officials in May 2025 that its platform brought this Austin charter to that pass rate. ProPublica reports TEA’s results don’t back it up. It got a third straight F.



Ask the district that runs this bus.

TEA says it left the choice to each district. Alpha's platform is now often called TimeBack. Ask at your school board's next meeting whether yours was approached about it and what a pilot must prove. A public information request asks it in writing.

